

STUDENT PERSONAL DEVICE USE

This policy covers the student use of personal technology devices in schools, including cell phones, laptops, tablets, smartwatches, earbuds, personal gaming devices, and other technologies during the school day.

A. Definitions.

1. "Bell to bell" means after the first bell rings at the start of the school day to begin instructional time until the dismissal bell rings at the end of the school day. "Bell to bell" includes lunch and time in between class periods.

2. "Personal device" means any personal electronic device that can connect to the internet and wirelessly collect, process, and transmit data, including smart watches and tablets.

3. "Cyberbullying" means bullying that occurs through the use of technology, through cell phones and other electronic devices, or technology capable of accessing the Internet.

B. Student Personal Device Use.

1. Students are not permitted to use personal devices from bell to bell while on Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) property in accordance with this policy and applicable laws. Only students with documented accommodations for an Individualized Education Plan (IEP), Section 504 Plan, individualized health care plan, or Limited English Proficiency Plan may possess and use a personal device on school property to either monitor or address a health concern or as an accommodation or assistive technology support.

2. During Instructional time, high school students must place personal technology devices in a classroom storage location, not on their person or otherwise immediately accessible. Personal technology devices must also be silenced during instructional time. Upon retrieval of their personal technology devices at the end of the instructional time, students must promptly secure their devices so that they are not immediately accessible, given that the use of such devices is not permitted bell to bell, to include in hallways and at lunch.

3. Students are permitted to use personal devices on school property before the first bell rings at the start of the school day or after the dismissal bell rings at the end of the school day.

4. Student personal devices are only permitted to use the LCPS-OPEN wireless network. Student personal devices are prohibited from accessing any other internal LCPS network, wired or wireless.

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5. All student personal devices used within school or at school functions must be free from anything that would violate the LCPS Student Rights and Responsibilities Handbook for Families and Student Code of Conduct (SR&R) or this policy, including using a Virtual Private Network (VPN), to subvert the division's protection measures.

6. Photography, audio, or video recording is prohibited in bathrooms, locker rooms, changing areas, or clinics. Students are prohibited from using phones, tablets, and other student personal devices in these areas unless there is a medical necessity or emergency.

7. Inappropriate use of social media, images, text messages, or videos shall not be permitted at any time on school property or during a school-sponsored activity; this includes while using LCPS school transportation.

8. Cyberbullying will not be tolerated in any form.

9. Any violation of this policy shall result in disciplinary action in accordance with the SR&R, as well as Policy 8210, Introduction to Student Discipline, which is incorporated therein.

C. School Staff Responsibilities.

1. School leadership will clearly communicate expectations to staff, students, and families.

2. Disciplinary practices for violation of this policy will conform to the procedures outlined in the SR&R.

D. Student and Parent/Guardian Responsibilities.

1. LCPS recognizes parents need to know how to contact their child in case of an emergency. If there is an emergency, parents may contact the main office of their child's school.

2. The student is solely responsible for their personal devices. The school and its staff are not liable for students' cell phones or other personal devices.

E. Exceptions.

Parents/Guardians, multi-disciplinary team members, including 504 teams and Individualized Education Plan teams, or other persons with knowledge of students who

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require access to personal devices as an accommodation, shall request such accommodations through their respective teams.

F. Policy Review.

This policy will be reviewed and updated regularly and as needed to address emerging issues and changes in technology use, but no less than every two years.

Adopted: 06/25/24

Revised: 12/16/25

Current Revision: 6/23/2026

Legal Refs: [Va. Code §§ 22.1-70.2](#), [22.1-79.3:1](#), [22.1-276.01](#)

Cross Refs: Policy [8210](#), Introduction to Student Discipline; [8250](#), Bullying Prevention and Education; and [8650](#), Student Technology Acceptable/Responsible Use Policy